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الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

A112T
Cultures
Main – All Branches
Midterm Exam

2025-2026/Summer Semester
Date: _3 August 2026____
2:30 – 4:30

Number of Exam Pages: 3 (including this cover sheet)	Time Allowed: 2 Hours

INSTRUCTIONS

This Exam consists of TWO PARTS.

Part 1 contains 3 Short Answer Questions. You must choose TWO and fully answer them i PARAGRAPH FORMAT.

Part 2 contains 2 Essay Questions. You must choose ONE of them and fully answer it in ESSAY FORMAT.

Write the question number next to each answer.

Do not answer more questions than required.

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Part 1: Short Answer Questions

(10 points = 5 points for each answer)

Please choose TWO of the following questions and respond to them in paragraph format. Each answer should be approximately 80 words long, addressing all relevant aspects of the question with appropriate evidence from the course material. Ensure that each paragraph includes a clear topic sentence, supporting details, and a conclusion.

1. What does **Panhellenic** mean, and what examples show its role in uniting Greek city-states?
2. What is the **Colosseum**, what activities took place there, and how does it reflect Roman engineering and social hierarchy?
3. Who were the **Flavian emperors**, and what major achievements and developments are associated with their rule?

Part 2: Essay Questions

(20 points)

Please choose ONE of the essay prompts below and write a comprehensive response in essay format. Your essay should be around 350 words, covering all relevant aspects of the question and backed by evidence from the course material. Make sure to structure your essay with an introduction, multiple body paragraphs, and a conclusion.

4. Discuss the ***Oikos*** in classical Athens and explain its **structure**, **members**, **duties**, and **social meaning**.

   Sub-Questions (20 marks total — 4 marks each)

   a. What was the *Oikos* in ancient Athens? (4 Marks)
   b. Describe the layout, members, and daily tasks associated with the *Oikos*. (4 Marks)
   c. Explain the rights and responsibilities of people within the household. (4 Marks)
   d. Give one example of how the *Oikos* reflected Athenian social values. (4 Marks)
   e. Why did the ideal of the *Oikos* often differ from reality in Athenian life? (4 Marks)

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5. **Compare** how **Suetonius** and **Tacitus** describe **Nero**, and explain how much their accounts may have been **shaped** by **Flavian political interests.**

Sub-Questions (20 marks total — 4 marks each)

a. Who was Suetonius, what was his connection to the Flavian emperors, and how did he describe Nero? (4 Marks)

b. Who was Tacitus, what was his connection to the Flavian emperors, and how did he describe Nero? (4 Marks)

c. How are Suetonius' and Tacitus' accounts of Nero similar? (4 Marks)

d. How are Suetonius' and Tacitus' accounts of Nero different? (4 Marks)

e. To what extent did Flavian political interests shape both authors' portrayals of Nero? (4 Marks)

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End of the Exam!



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